

ALEXANDRA SIMONE GORDON

Teaching Artist • Community Arts Builder • Event Producer • Tarot Practitioner

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Portfolio & Services: imalexofalltrades.netlify.app

ARTIST'S STATEMENT & PROFILE

Multidisciplinary artist, educator, and community builder with 13+ years of creative practice spanning theater direction, dance, poetry, music, event production, and intuitive tarot. A decade-long career at the intersection of arts integration and education in NYC public schools produced grant-funded productions, city-wide cultural partnerships, and programming that transformed classrooms into performance spaces and communities into collaborators. Currently building Alex of All Trades as a St. Louis-based and nationwide practice: offering arts-integrated workshops, tarot and spiritual guidance, moon circle community gatherings, and event production rooted in creativity, healing, and collective transformation. Every artistic practice I bring is grounded in the same belief: that expression is a form of access, and that community is built one shared experience at a time.

GRANTS, AWARDS & INSTITUTIONAL HONORS

Shubert Foundation / MTI Broadway Junior Grant — Shubert Foundation & Music Theatre International

One of 15 schools selected city-wide to receive funding to create a full musical theater department. Directed sold-out production of "Once on This Island" at Highland Park Community School, Brooklyn (2016-2019).

Sing For Hope Grant — Sing For Hope

Received an originally designed Sing For Hope piano for the school community. Launched private and small-group piano instruction for students as a direct result of the grant.

NYC DOE Culturally Responsive-Sustaining Education (CRSE) Fellowship — New York City Department of Education

Selected as 1 of 50 educators city-wide to develop and disseminate culturally responsive, sustaining education curriculum and pedagogical practices for schools and communities across New York City.

Orpheus Chamber Concert Series Partnership — Orpheus Chamber Orchestra & Carnegie Hall

Established a school partnership providing free chamber music programming at Carnegie Hall for students, connecting underserved youth to world-class live performance.

Literacy Design Collaborative Selection — Literacy Design Collaborative

Selected for a structured, coaching-supported literacy curriculum development fellowship using backwards design frameworks.

Urban Advantage Science & Culture Partnership — NYC DOE & Partner Cultural Institutions

Selected for collaborative programming connecting public school classrooms to NYC zoos, botanical gardens, museums, and science centers for inquiry-based learning.

THEATER, PERFORMANCE & ARTS DIRECTION

Arts Director & Theater Program Founder • *Highland Park Community School* • 2016 – 2019 • Brooklyn, NY

- **Shubert Foundation Production:** Directed a full-scale, sold-out production of 'Once on This Island' with student cast and crew, building a musical theater program from the ground up with no prior infrastructure; secured and managed the Shubert Foundation and MTI Broadway Junior grant to fund the program.
- **Arts Education Liaison:** Served as school-wide Arts Education Liaison, working collaboratively with administration, staff, and cultural partners to ensure high-quality, sustained arts programming for the entire school community.
- **Music Programming:** Launched private and small-group piano lessons following receipt of a custom Sing For Hope piano; developed and strengthened a music appreciation program grounded in the Blueprint for the Arts framework.
- **Carnegie Hall Partnership:** Organized and chaperoned student attendance at Orpheus Chamber Concert Series performances at Carnegie Hall, providing direct access to professional live performance for students with limited arts exposure.
- **Interdisciplinary Arts Curriculum:** Developed and taught rigorous, performance-based curricula integrating theater, music, creative writing, and visual art across English, Social Studies, and ELA content areas for grades 6-8.

Performance Program Designer • *Brownsville Collaborative Middle School* • 2014 – 2016 • Brooklyn, NY

- **Poetry at the Met:** Designed and led 4 immersive poetry writing workshops with trips to the Metropolitan Museum of Art, using visual art as a catalyst for student creative writing, self-expression, and critical analysis.
- **Film Club:** Founded and led a Film Club providing exposure to classic and contemporary cinema; students developed film literacy through written critique and analytical discussion.
- **Performance-Based Curriculum:** Designed immersive, performance-based curricula that centered student talents, skills, and artistic identities within a bridge-class setting, creating spaces for creative risk-taking alongside academic rigor.

Theater & Arts Collaborator (Independent) • *Karaoke Burlesque Troupe & Arts Community* • Various • New York, NY

- **Stage Manager & Consultant:** Served as stage manager and arts consultant for a burlesque troupe, contributing organizational leadership, stage management expertise, creative direction, and ensemble energy to live performance productions.
- **Community Arts Leadership:** Identified as a natural leader and creative anchor across collaborative artistic projects; known for bringing positive energy, organizational clarity, and deep respect for each performer's contribution to the ensemble.

DANCE, MOVEMENT & EMBODIED ARTS

Teaching Artist & Movement Educator • *Beacon Center for Arts & Leadership, Coalition for Hispanic Family Services* • June – Sept 2013 • Bushwick, NY

- **Original Curriculum: Get In My Circle:** Designed and facilitated 'Get In My Circle: Introduction to Hula Hoop and Hoop Dance', a fully original dance, movement, and life skills curriculum for 80 students ages 8-15, integrating hip-hop, jazz, modern, and ballet dance forms with music appreciation and technical circus skills.
- **Culminating Performance:** Produced and directed a successful final multi-media performance for an audience of 200 people, managing all aspects of production, performance preparation, and student presentation.
- **Youth Leadership Integration:** Managed a staff of 4-6 youth workers ages 15-23, providing leadership development, mentoring, and college advising alongside artistic direction, centering youth agency within the creative process.
- **Community & Expression:** Built a program explicitly connecting movement, music, self-expression, teamwork, and community, using the arts as a vehicle for social-emotional development and collective belonging.

Get In My Circle (Continued Programs):

- Reprised Get In My Circle at New Voices School for Academic and Creative Arts (Brooklyn, 2019-2020) as part of NIA After School Programming, developing new choreography and building a new cohort of student performers.
- Also delivered as a standalone after-school dance and fitness program, building on the original curriculum and expanding the movement vocabulary for each new student community.

POETRY & LITERARY ARTS

Poetry Club Founder & Facilitator • *Multiple NYC Schools* • 2014 – 2023

- **Poetry Club:** Founded and facilitated Poetry Club at New Voices School (2019-2020), meeting three times weekly; led students through reading and analysis of multiple poets and poetic forms, culminating in a collaborative, original poetry collection.
- **Poetry at the Met:** Designed 4 immersive poetry writing workshops for Brownsville Collaborative students at the Metropolitan Museum of Art, pairing ekphrastic writing with museum-based inquiry to produce deeply personal and analytically rich student work.
- **Cross-Content Poetry Integration:** Integrated poetry writing and analysis into ELA, Social Studies, and Arts curricula across five NYC schools, centering student voice and creative expression as core academic practices.

TAROT PRACTICE & SPIRITUAL COMMUNITY ARTS

Tarot Practitioner & Moon Circle Facilitator • *Alex of All Trades (Independent Practice)* • 2011 – Present

- **13+ Years of Practice:** Engaged in serious, sustained tarot study and practice since 2011, evolving from personal framework for clarity and reflection into a professional service offering rooted in depth, care, and 13+ years of intuitive experience.
- **Individual Readings:** Offer 30, 60, and 90-minute individual tarot readings (virtual and in-person, St. Louis metro area) spanning focused single-question sessions, comprehensive Celtic Cross readings, and deep life-path and transition readings, with audio/video recording and written follow-up notes.
- **Couples & Relationship Readings:** Facilitate couples and relationship dynamic readings for romantic, family, and professional partnerships, creating a shared reflective space with actionable insights for both participants.
- **Moon Circle Gatherings:** Host monthly New Moon and Full Moon community circles combining group tarot reading, collective reflection, intention setting, and community ritual; available virtually and in-person in the St. Louis metro area.
- **Arts Integration & Community Events:** Design and facilitate tarot and arts integration workshops, reflective rituals for groups and organizations, and community healing events for nonprofits, schools, and community organizations; private event bookings available.
- **Philosophical Foundation:** Practice is grounded in the belief that tarot does not predict but illuminates: serving as a framework for clarifying feelings, recognizing patterns, and locating the courage and tools to move forward, with confidentiality, care, and respect at the center of every session.

EVENT PRODUCTION & COMMUNITY BUILDING

Event Producer & Community Organizer • *Multiple Contexts* • 2013 – Present

- **Performing Arts Camp Production:** Produced and directed all program-wide events at Beacon Center for Arts and Leadership's performing arts camp, including a talent show, scavenger hunt, field days, and a 200-person final multi-media performance, managing all logistics, materials, and student/staff coordination.
- **PBL End-of-Year Symposium:** Organized and produced the annual Project-Based Learning End-of-Year Symposium at Highland Park Community School, coordinating student presentations, community attendance, and all event logistics as Grade Team Lead.
- **Senior Events:** Organized and produced 8th-grade prom, graduation ceremonies, and culminating academic events, managing full event production from venue to program to day-of execution.
- **Monthly Community Events & Cultural Programming:** Built and sustained regular community events as an instructional coach and teacher, including monthly staff community events, seasonal celebrations, instructional book studies, and collaborative professional gatherings grounded in connection and shared growth.
- **Virtual Event Production:** Produce and manage full virtual events and professional webinars including complete tech setup, speaker coordination, live chat and Q&A moderation, and post-event resource delivery, with specialized experience in AI training and professional learning webinars.
- **Moon Circles & Spiritual Community Events:** Host regular New Moon and Full Moon community circles as ongoing community-building events, creating recurring, accessible spaces for reflection, ritual, and collective belonging in the St. Louis metro area and virtually nationwide.
- **Hookah Bar Event Host & Manager:** Managed operations and hosted community events during and after college, building foundational skills in space-holding, community facilitation, and event coordination across diverse audiences.

CULTURAL PARTNERSHIPS & COMMUNITY ARTS WORK

- Metropolitan Museum of Art: Poetry at the Met workshop series, 4 immersive student writing and art analysis sessions.
- Carnegie Hall / Orpheus Chamber Orchestra: Student attendance at professional chamber music performances through the Orpheus Chamber Concert Series partnership.
- Shubert Foundation & Music Theatre International: Grant recipient for full musical theater program; produced and directed 'Once on This Island'.
- Sing For Hope: Grant recipient for a custom-designed Sing For Hope piano; launched piano instruction for the school community.
- Brooklyn Museum: Participant in Brooklyn Museum Educators Evening through Art in the Classroom fellowship.
- Coalition for Hispanic Family Services: Teaching artist in residence at Beacon Center for Arts and Leadership, Bushwick.
- Urban Advantage Network: Programming in collaboration with NYC zoos, botanical gardens, museums, and science centers.
- Oranim Ofek Regional High School, Kibbutz Evron, Israel: Taught English and developed curriculum in an international cross-cultural arts and education setting (2009-2010).

CREATIVE SKILLS & DISCIPLINES

- Theater Direction & Production
- Performance-Based Curriculum Design
- Dance: Hip-Hop, Jazz, Modern, Ballet, Hoop
- Poetry Writing, Analysis & Facilitation
- Piano Instruction (Private & Group)
- Tarot Reading & Intuitive Facilitation
- Moon Circle & Community Ritual Facilitation
- Event Production & Stage Management
- Arts Integration Across Content Areas
- Community Building & Space-Holding
- Copyediting & Creative Writing
- Zoom Production & Live Event Facilitation

EDUCATION

M.S., Special Education and Teaching

Long Island University, Brooklyn Campus | GPA: 3.91 | Summa Cum Laude

Social justice-driven program grounded in urban studies, community-centered pedagogy, and student advocacy

B.A., Cultural Anthropology

Binghamton University | GPA: 3.71 | Magna Cum Laude | Phi Eta Sigma Honors Society

A discipline rooted in studying how humans make meaning, build community, and transmit culture — the lens behind every artistic practice

Certificate, TEFL: Teaching English as a Foreign Language

Via Lingua, Crete, Greece | International arts and education experience; learned foundational Greek as a language learner

CURRENT ARTS & COMMUNITY SERVICES (ALEX OF ALL TRADES)

- Tarot Readings: Individual sessions (30, 60, 90 min), couples readings, and reading packages. Virtual and in-person (St. Louis metro area).
- Moon Circles: Monthly New Moon and Full Moon community gatherings with group reading, intention setting, and community ritual. Virtual and in-person.
- Arts Integration Workshops: Tarot, movement, poetry, and creative expression workshops for schools, nonprofits, community organizations, and private groups.
- Community Events: Private bookings for group readings, retreats, bachelorette and birthday events, corporate wellness, and team-building experiences.
- Event Production: Full event and virtual webinar production services, including tech management, facilitation, speaker support, and coordination.
- Copyediting & Creative Writing Support: Long-form and short-form editing, thought leadership content, and creative writing guidance.